

NovaTech Solutions — Privacy and Security Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This Privacy and Security Policy describes how NovaTech Solutions collects, stores, processes, and protects data across its five core products — NovaTech CRM, NovaTech Projects, NovaTech Connect, NovaTech Insights, and NovaTech Helpdesk. It applies to data belonging to NovaTech customers ("Customer Data," meaning the business data customers input into the platform) as well as data NovaTech collects about individual users in connection with providing and improving the service ("Account Data"). This policy is incorporated by reference into NovaTech's Terms of Service and, for applicable customers, into a Data Processing Agreement (DPA) available upon request.

2. Data Collection

NovaTech collects the following categories of data:

Category	Examples	Purpose
Account Data	Name, email, phone number, job title, organization	Account creation, authentication, communication
Customer Data	CRM records, project tasks, messages, tickets, uploaded files	Core product functionality
Usage Data	Feature usage patterns, login timestamps, session duration	Product improvement, security monitoring
Device and Technical Data	IP address, browser type, operating system	Security, troubleshooting, fraud prevention
Billing Data	Payment method details (tokenized), billing address	Subscription billing and tax compliance
Support Interaction Data	Support ticket content, chat transcripts	Issue resolution, quality improvement

Payment card information is never stored directly on NovaTech's systems; all payment processing is handled through PCI DSS-compliant third-party payment processors, and NovaTech retains only a tokenized reference sufficient for billing purposes.

Customer Data entered into NovaTech products (contacts, deals, tasks, messages, tickets, and similar business records) remains the property of the customer at all times. NovaTech acts as a data processor with respect to this data and does not use Customer Data for its own marketing or analytics purposes beyond what is necessary to operate, secure, and support the platform.

3. Data Storage and Residency

Customer Data is stored in NovaTech's cloud infrastructure, hosted across geographically distributed data centers. Customers select a data residency region during account setup, with availability scaling by edition as described in the Order Provisioning and Delivery Policy (Document 7), Section 7:

Edition	Available Regions
Starter	United States
Professional	United States or European Union
Enterprise	United States, European Union, Asia-Pacific, or custom arrangement

Within a selected region, data is replicated across multiple physically separate facilities to support availability and disaster recovery, but replication does not cross the customer's selected regional boundary except for anonymized or aggregated operational metrics used for platform-wide reliability monitoring.

Note: Backup data described in the Warranty and Service Policy (Document 6), Section 8, is stored within the same regional boundary as the primary data it backs up.

4. Encryption Standards

- **Data in transit** is encrypted using TLS 1.2 or higher across all product interfaces, including web application, mobile applications, desktop applications, and API access.
- **Data at rest** is encrypted using AES-256 encryption across all production databases and file storage systems.
- **Encryption key management** follows industry-standard key rotation practices, with keys managed through a dedicated key management service separate from the data storage layer.
- **Backups** are encrypted using the same at-rest standards as production data.

Enterprise customers with heightened compliance requirements may request additional detail on NovaTech's encryption architecture through their Customer Success Manager, subject to a mutual non-disclosure agreement given the sensitivity of infrastructure security detail.

5. GDPR and Regional Privacy Compliance

NovaTech Solutions maintains compliance programs addressing multiple regional privacy frameworks, including the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA) and California Privacy Rights Act (CPRA), and the UK GDPR.

For customers and users within scope of GDPR:

- NovaTech acts as a **data processor** for Customer Data entered into the platform, with the customer organization acting as the **data controller**.
- A Data Processing Agreement (DPA), incorporating Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) for applicable international transfers, is available to all customers upon request through Admin Console > Legal Documents or by contacting privacy@novatechsolutions.com.
- NovaTech maintains a Record of Processing Activities (RoPA) as required under GDPR Article 30.
- Sub-processors engaged by NovaTech (such as cloud infrastructure and payment processing providers) are listed in NovaTech's published Sub-Processor List, updated

as changes occur, with advance notice provided to customers for material additions.

For customers subject to CCPA/CPRA, NovaTech does not sell personal information as defined under California law, and provides mechanisms for California residents to exercise applicable rights as described in Section 6.

6. User Rights and Data Requests

Depending on applicable regional law, individual users may have the right to:

- **Access** a copy of the personal data NovaTech holds about them.
- **Correct** inaccurate personal data.
- **Delete** personal data, subject to legal retention obligations and legitimate business need (such as active fraud investigation or unresolved billing disputes).
- **Restrict or object to** certain processing activities.
- **Port** their data to another provider in a structured, commonly used format.

Submitting a data rights request:

1. Individual users can submit requests directly through Settings > Privacy > My Data, or by emailing privacy@novatechsolutions.com.
2. For requests concerning data controlled by a customer organization (i.e., business records entered by an employer into NovaTech products), NovaTech directs the individual to the relevant organization, since the organization acts as the data controller for that data under GDPR's controller/processor framework; NovaTech will assist the controller organization in fulfilling such requests.
3. NovaTech responds to verified requests within 30 days, consistent with applicable regulatory timelines, and may extend this by an additional 30 days for complex requests with notice to the requester.

Note: Requests to delete data that is subject to a legal hold, active billing dispute, or ongoing security investigation may be delayed until the underlying matter is resolved, with the requester notified of the reason for delay.

7. Cookies and Tracking Technologies

NovaTech's web application and marketing website use cookies and similar technologies for the following purposes:

Cookie Category	Purpose	Can Be Disabled?
Strictly Necessary	Authentication, session management, security	No — required for core functionality
Functional	Remembering user preferences (theme, layout)	Yes, via Cookie Settings
Analytics	Understanding aggregate feature usage to guide product improvement	Yes, via Cookie Settings
Marketing (marketing website only)	Measuring campaign effectiveness on novatechsolutions.com	Yes, via Cookie Settings

Cookie preferences can be managed at any time through the Cookie Settings link in the website footer or, for logged-in application users, under Settings > Privacy > Cookie Preferences. Disabling strictly necessary cookies is not possible, as they are required for basic authentication and security functions.

8. Account Security Controls

NovaTech provides a layered set of account security controls, described in operational detail in the Account Management Guide (Document 9):

- Multi-factor authentication (TOTP, SMS, and FIDO2/WebAuthn hardware keys, availability varying by edition)
- Single Sign-On with SAML 2.0, and SCIM-based automatic provisioning/deprovisioning on Enterprise
- Configurable session timeout policies, down to a 15-minute minimum on Enterprise
- IP allowlisting to restrict login to approved network ranges (Enterprise)
- Audit logging of authentication events, permission changes, and data exports, with retention scaling from 30 days (Starter) to unlimited (Enterprise)
- Automated account lockout after repeated failed login attempts

Administrators are responsible for configuring and enforcing these controls at a level appropriate to their organization's risk profile and regulatory obligations, as described further in Section 11 of this policy.

9. Incident Response

NovaTech maintains a formal Incident Response Plan governing the detection, containment, investigation, and communication of security incidents affecting customer data or platform availability.

Incident response process:

- 1. **Detection** — Automated monitoring systems and staff vigilance identify a potential incident.
- 2. **Triage and Containment** — The Security team assesses scope and takes immediate containment action to limit further exposure.
- 3. **Investigation** — Root cause analysis determines the nature and extent of the incident, including which customers or data may be affected.
- 4. **Notification** — For incidents confirmed to affect customer data, NovaTech notifies affected customers without undue delay and, where required by applicable law, within 72 hours of confirming the incident's impact.
- 5. **Remediation** — Underlying vulnerabilities or process gaps are addressed, with a post-incident review conducted for incidents of significant scope.

Notification to affected customers includes, to the extent known at the time: the nature of the incident, categories of data involved, steps NovaTech has taken, and recommended actions for the customer. Enterprise customers with specific contractual notification requirements (such as a shorter notification window) are notified according to those negotiated terms where they exceed this general policy's commitments.

Suspected security vulnerabilities can be reported at any time to security@novatechsolutions.com or through NovaTech's responsible disclosure program, which includes a bug bounty for qualifying verified reports from external researchers.

10. Compliance Certifications

NovaTech Solutions maintains the following certifications and attestations, renewed on the indicated cadence:

Certification/Framework	Renewal Cadence
SOC 2 Type II	Annual
ISO/IEC 27001	Annual surveillance audit, full recertification every 3 years
GDPR Compliance Program	Ongoing, reviewed annually
CCPA/CPRA Compliance Program	Ongoing, reviewed annually
Third-Party Penetration Testing	At minimum annual

Copies of current certification summaries and audit reports are available to customers under NDA through Admin Console > Legal Documents > Compliance Reports, or by request through a Customer Success Manager for Enterprise accounts.

11. Security Best Practices for Customers

While NovaTech secures the underlying platform infrastructure, customers share responsibility for securing their own account configuration and user behavior:

- Enforce multi-factor authentication organization-wide, particularly for administrator-level accounts.
 - Configure session timeout and IP allowlisting policies appropriate to your organization's risk profile.
 - Promptly deactivate departing employees' accounts (see Account Management Guide, Document 9, Section 10).
 - Periodically review the Audit Log for unfamiliar activity, particularly permission changes and large data exports.
 - Limit administrator role assignment to the minimum number of individuals necessary for effective account governance.
 - Review connected third-party integrations and Marketplace applications periodically, removing any that are no longer in active use.
 - For Enterprise customers with especially sensitive data, consider requiring hardware security keys over SMS-based MFA, given the greater resistance of hardware keys to phishing and SIM-swapping attacks.
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12. Data Retention and Deletion

Data retention follows a consistent structure across products:

- **Active subscription:** Data is retained for the duration of the active subscription.
- **Following cancellation:** Data remains accessible in a read-only, exportable state for 30 days, per the Pricing and Subscription Guide, Section 12.
- **Following account deletion request:** A 30-day pending deletion window applies, after which data is permanently deleted from production systems, with backup copies purged within the subsequent backup retention cycle (35 days standard, up to 180 days for Enterprise customers with Extended Backup Retention).
- **Audit logs:** Retained per edition as described in Section 8, independent of the underlying data's own retention status, to preserve a security record even after data deletion.

Certain data may be retained longer than standard timelines where required to comply with legal obligations, resolve disputes, or enforce NovaTech's agreements, in which case such data is restricted from general use and retained solely for the applicable purpose.

13. Summary

NovaTech Solutions collects and processes Account Data and Customer Data solely to operate, secure, and support its product suite, applying TLS 1.2+ encryption in transit and AES-256 encryption at rest across all products. NovaTech maintains formal compliance programs for GDPR, CCPA/CPRA, and other applicable regional frameworks, supported by SOC 2 Type II and ISO/IEC 27001 certifications. Customers select their data residency region at setup, retain full ownership of Customer Data, and share responsibility for configuring account-level security controls such as MFA and session policies. A formal Incident Response process governs breach detection and notification, and data is retained according to a consistent schedule tied to subscription status, cancellation, and deletion requests. This policy should be read alongside the Account Management Guide (Document 9) for user-level security configuration and the Warranty and Service Policy (Document 6) for backup and data recovery commitments.

End of Document 10 — Privacy and Security Policy. NovaTech Solutions Confidential Documentation.

End of Documentation Set

This concludes the ten-document NovaTech Solutions knowledge base: Product Catalog, Pricing and Subscription Guide, Customer Support Reference Guide, Troubleshooting Guide, Product User Manual, Warranty and Service Policy, Order Provisioning and Delivery Policy, Return and Refund Policy, Account Management Guide, and Privacy and Security Policy. All ten documents are internally consistent in product names, edition structure (Starter/Professional/Enterprise), pricing references, and cross-references, and are formatted for direct use in a Retrieval-Augmented Generation knowledge base or conversion to PDF.